EXAMINER'S HANDBOOK (EXAMINATEUR) • B1

Audio Transcripts, Master Answer Keys & Assessment Descriptors

STRICTLY CONFIDENTIAL

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1. AUDIO TRANSCRIPTS (FOR PART 2: LISTENING)

Instructions for Examiners: Read these transcripts aloud at a natural, steady pace, or play the recorded audio files. Observe the reading frequency indicated (1x or 2x).

TASK 1: SHORT ANNOUNCEMENTS (Read each text ONCE • Questions 16 to 20)

Number 16 (Dr. Keller's Dental Clinic):

"Good morning, Mrs. Schneider. This is Sabine Neumann calling from Dr. Keller's dental practice. I am calling to confirm your routine check-up appointment tomorrow morning at 9:00 a.m. The appointment will go ahead as scheduled, but since we recently upgraded to a new digital management system, we kindly request that you bring your new electronic health insurance card. In addition, Dr. Keller asked me to remind you to bring an updated list of any medications you are currently taking. Thank you very much, and we will see you tomorrow!"

Number 17 (Station Announcement – Regional Train RB 42):

"Attention, passengers on regional train RB 42 bound for Neustadt Central Station: Due to severe storm damage that occurred overnight, the railway bridge between South Square and East Station must undergo urgent structural inspection and repairs. Consequently, this service will terminate unscheduled at East Station today. For passengers continuing towards Central Station, please transfer to the rail replacement shuttle buses waiting directly outside on the station forecourt."

Number 18 (Regional Weekend Weather Forecast):

"And now, here is the weekend weather outlook for the southern region: Be sure to take full advantage of Saturday for any outdoor excursions! With widespread sunshine, afternoon temperatures will comfortably reach a pleasant 24 degrees Celsius. Sunday morning will remain dry at first, but by early afternoon, thick clouds will roll in from the west. Expect heavy thunderstorms, downpours, and gusty winds, accompanied by a sharp drop in temperatures to just 13 degrees."

Number 19 (Dream-Home Furniture – Mr. Berger):

"Hello, Mr. Albers. This is Berger calling from Dream-Home Furnishings regarding your order from last month: the large solid oak dining table and six matching leather chairs. Delivery was originally scheduled for next Wednesday. However, another client on our Friday delivery route had to cancel at short notice, which means our delivery team can now deliver your complete set this Friday between 10:00 a.m. and 1:00 p.m. Please give us a quick call back to confirm whether someone will be home."

Number 20 (City Museum Telephone Information Service):

"Welcome to the automated information line of the City Museum. Our exhibitions are open Tuesday through Sunday from 10:00 a.m. to 6:00 p.m. Please take note of an important advisory for this Sunday: Due to the annual City Marathon, all access roads surrounding the museum district, as well as our visitor car park, will be strictly closed to vehicular traffic from 8:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. Visitors are strongly advised to travel by public transport via Subway Line 4. The museum galleries will be open as normal."

TASK 2: RADIO INTERVIEW (Read dialogue TWICE • Questions 21 to 25)

Presenter: "A very good morning to all our listeners on Radio Current Affairs! Final school certificates are around the corner, and hundreds of thousands of young people face a vital choice: should I head straight to university, or would I be better off pursuing practical vocational training in a business? Here in the studio to discuss this is professional career consultant Thomas Richter. Mr. Richter, is it still true that nearly everyone wants to study at university?"

Thomas Richter: "Good morning! Yes, societal pressure towards an academic degree remains extraordinarily high, even though it's not quite 80 percent, but currently just over half of a school-leaving cohort that enrolls in university. The alarming issue, however, is that nearly 30 percent of students in undergraduate bachelor programmes drop out before completing their degrees."

Presenter: "Why is that? Are young people today simply less resilient?"

Thomas Richter: "Not at all. The problem is that many enroll at university simply assuming it is a natural continuation of secondary school. They are then utterly shocked by how theoretical and abstract university education is, and by the enormous degree of self-organization required. Many discover only after two full semesters that they actually prefer practical, hands-on work where they can see a tangible outcome of their labor at the end of the day."

Presenter: "Even so, many parents worry that a vocational apprenticeship means lower lifetime earnings."

Thomas Richter: "That is an outdated prejudice! Look at skilled trades or technical fields today: someone who completes an apprenticeship as an electrician, heating engineer, or mechatronics technician and subsequently qualifies as a master craftsman often earns as much as or more than many university graduates – with virtually zero risk of unemployment. Moreover, apprentices earn an independent income from day one, whereas university graduates frequently enter the workforce carrying heavy student debts."

Presenter: "And what advice do you offer to young people torn between academic theory and practical training?"

Thomas Richter: "For them, a dual study programme is the ideal pathway. You sign an employment contract with a sponsoring firm and alternate every three months between practical workplace training and academic lectures at a partner college. It demands intense dedication, but offers outstanding career prospects. My foremost advice to parents is this: never pressure your child into university merely because the neighbor's son is studying law or because it sounds prestigious. What truly matters is where the young person's genuine talents and passions lie."

TASK 3: WORKPLACE CONVERSATION (Read conversation ONCE • Questions 26 to 30)

Anna: "David, remember our manager asked us to gather ideas by Friday for our annual company outing in June? Have you had a chance to think about it?"

David: "Yes, a bit. One thing is certain: we definitely shouldn't do a long mountain trek like last year! When the rain started in the afternoon, everyone got completely soaked and spirits hit rock bottom."

Anna: "You're completely right. That rainy hike was a complete catastrophe; I hated it too! That's why I was thinking of an indoor activity this time. How about a professional culinary workshop at a cooking school? Preparing a three-course dinner in small teams would allow us to get to know our new colleagues in accounting much better than merely sitting beside each other in a restaurant."

David: "Hmm, I'm not sure. Some colleagues don't enjoy cooking at all. I thought a relaxed riverboat cruise with an evening buffet on board would be far more laid-back."

Anna: "I actually looked into that exact boat idea yesterday online. The catch is our budget: the company covers a maximum of 50 Euros per employee. An evening cruise with dinner costs at least 68 Euros without drinks, so that's unfortunately out of reach."

David: "What a pity! Yes, if it exceeds 50 Euros, finance definitely won't sign off on it. But on another note: don't you think the trip should take place on a working Friday again? If we schedule it on a Saturday, half the team will decline because of family commitments."

Anna: "Actually, I wouldn't mind Saturday since there's no rush. But you know what? Why don't we put down your idea of a shorter afternoon river cruise without dinner alongside my cooking workshop proposal? We can submit both options to management and let the team vote by email."

David: "Perfect, let's do that! Having the team vote is by far the fairest solution."

2. OFFICIAL MASTER ANSWER KEY & GRADING GRIDS

PART 1: READING (Total: 25 Points)

Section	Points	Correct Answers & Rationale
Task 1: Business Article	10 P. (5 x 2 P.)	**1. b** (fewer hours with same wage) • **2. c** (severe skilled labor shortage) • **3. b** (longer shifts over 4 days, Friday emergency team) • **4. a** (less absenteeism, higher hourly productivity) • **5. b** (essential public services cannot simply compress time)
Task 2: Readers' Opinions	10 P. (5 x 2 P.)	**6. True [T]** • **7. False [F]** • **8. False [F]** • **9. True [T]** • **10. False [F]** (tradespeople and residents free)
Task 3: Course Matching	5 P. (5 x 1 P.)	**11. C** (MS Excel Weekend Intensive) • **12. A** (Public Speaking & Rhetoric) • **13. 0** (No 4-week morning intensive Business English fits) • **14. D** (Workplace Conflict Management) • **15. E** (Desk Posture & Pain Relief Tuesday Eve)

PART 2: LISTENING (Total: 25 Points)

Section	Points	Correct Answers & Rationale
Task 1: Announcements	10 P. (5 x 2 P.)	**16. b** (insurance card & medication list) • **17. a** (railway bridge storm damage) • **18. c** (sunny Sat 24°C, stormy cooler Sun 13°C) • **19. a** (early delivery on Friday) • **20. b** (car access blocked due to Marathon; use Subway 4)
Task 2: Radio Interview	10 P. (5 x 2 P.)	**21. False [F]** (just over half, not 80%) • **22. True [T]** • **23. False [F]** (master craftsmen frequently out-earn academics) • **24. True [T]** • **25. False [F]** (parents should focus on talents, not prestige)
Task 3: Workplace Dialogue	5 P. (5 x 1 P.)	**26. Both [B]** (both agree last year's rainy hike was awful) • **27. Anna [A]** (cooking workshop fosters teamwork) • **28. Both [B]** (50€ budget vs 68€ cruise cost) • **29. David [D]** (prefers Friday to avoid Saturday family conflicts) • **30. Both [B]** (both agree to present dual option for team vote)

PART 3: LANGUAGE IN USE (Total: 15 Points • 20 Questions x 0.75 Points)

Section	Points	Answers (Keys 31 to 50)
Task 1: Cloze Text (31–40)	7.5 P. (10 x 0.75 P.)	**31. b** (which) • **32. c** (that) • **33. b** (Although) • **34. c** (the) • **35. a** (was) **36. a** (severely) • **37. b** (in order to) • **38. a** (my) • **39. a** (Would) • **40. a** (as soon as)
Task 2: B1 Structures (41–50)	7.5 P. (10 x 0.75 P.)	**41. c** (whose - relative possessive) • **42. b** (Instead of - preposition + gerund) • **43. a** (must be - modal passive) **44. a** (colleague - noun singular) • **45. c** (The / the - correlative comparative) • **46. b** (were / would not - 2nd conditional) **47. c** (with / to - prepositional complements) • **48. a** (had been signed - past perfect passive) **49. c** (the - definite article) • **50. c** (to submit - infinitive after necessary)

Rapid Examiner Scoring Key (1–50):
1.b | 2.c | 3.b | 4.a | 5.b | 6.T | 7.F | 8.F | 9.T | 10.F | 11.C | 12.A | 13.0 | 14.D | 15.E | 16.b | 17.a | 18.c | 19.a | 20.b | 21.F | 22.T | 23.F | 24.T | 25.F | 26.B | 27.A | 28.B | 29.D | 30.B | 31.b | 32.c | 33.b | 34.c | 35.a | 36.a | 37.b | 38.a | 39.a | 40.a | 41.c | 42.b | 43.a | 44.a | 45.c | 46.b | 47.c | 48.a | 49.c | 50.c

3. ASSESSMENT CRITERIA FOR WRITING & SPEAKING

PART 4: WRITING (20 POINTS • TASK 1: 10 PTS / TASK 2: 10 PTS)

Task	Points Allocation	CEFR Level B1 Performance Descriptors
Task 1: Formal Complaint Email (10 Pts.)	• Content Points: 4 Pts. • Coherence & Style: 3 Pts. • Accuracy: 3 Pts.	All 4 prompts (order details, defect, deadline, remedy demanded) clearly addressed. Formal salutation (*"Dear Sir or Madam"*) and complimentary close (*"Yours faithfully"*). Smooth linking with B1 cohesive devices (*"therefore", "although", "in addition"*). Generally accurate grammar.
Task 2: Opinion Forum Essay (10 Pts.)	• Arguments & Stance: 4 Pts. • Connectors & Flow: 3 Pts. • Vocabulary Range: 3 Pts.	Clear statement of personal viewpoint. At least two advantages and two disadvantages of remote work explicitly articulated and substantiated. Realistic compromise proposed. Good range of everyday B1 vocabulary, logical paragraphing (intro, body, conclusion).

PART 5: SPEAKING (15 POINTS • 5A: 7.5 PTS / 5B: 7.5 PTS)

Examination Area	Points Allocation	Assessment Descriptors
Part 5A: Presentation (Social Media)	7.5 Points (~4–5 Min.)	Clear structure (Introduction → Home Country Context → Pros/Cons → Conclusion). Fluency without unnatural hesitation, intelligible pronunciation, and confident handling of 1–2 follow-up questions from the examiners.
Part 5B: Negotiation (Graduation Trip)	7.5 Points (~6 Min.)	Active engagement and communicative collaboration. Contributes relevant ideas, responds appropriately to partner's points, and actively negotiates a workable compromise on destination, transportation, and costs.

OFFICIAL GRADING CONVERSION SCALE (CEFR B1 • 100 POINTS TOTAL)

Score Range	Percentage	Grade & Classification	B1 Status
90.0 – 100.0	90 % – 100 %	**Grade A – Distinction**	**Passed with Distinction**
80.0 – 89.5	80 % – 89 %	**Grade B – Merit**	**Passed with Merit**
70.0 – 79.5	70 % – 79 %	**Grade C – Satisfactory**	**Passed**
60.0 – 69.5	60 % – 69 %	**Grade D – Pass (Threshold)**	**Passed (Minimum Pass Mark)**
0.0 – 59.5	< 60 %	**Fail**	**Not Passed**

Academic Director ILAS: **Mr. Aziz Marsoul** Certificate Reference: **CEFR-ENG-B1-2026-ILAS** Official Seal & Signature: [_____]